

THE COMMANDMENT OF ENTRY

I failed networking marketing four times because subconsciously I possessed the truth: The road was a violation to the Commandment of Entry.

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The Commandment of Entry states that *as entry barriers to any business road fall, or lessen, the effectiveness of that road declines while competition in that field subsequently strengthens*. Higher entry barriers equate to stronger, more powerful roads with less competition and less need for exceptionality.

Low-barrier-entry businesses are weak roads because easy entry creates high competition and high traffic, all of which share the same pie. And where there is traffic, there is no movement.

In other words, if “getting into business” is as simple as paying \$200 for a distributor kit, there are no entry barriers, and the opportunity should be passed. If any Joe Blow napping behind Chan’s Chinese restaurant in the alley next to a dumpster can start your business in minutes, it isn’t a business you want to be doing! The world is littered with so-called businesses that have no entry barriers. And that is why they suck and the people who follow them aren’t rich.

A decade ago the big buzz was “Make millions on eBay!” It didn’t last long because this opportunity eventually violated the Commandment of Entry. If you could create an eBay business in 10 minutes, guess what? So could millions of other people. And who made the millions? The early adopters, eBay, and eBay’s founders. They drove the Fastlane and picked up millions of hitchhikers along the way. Few did well, while millions did not.

The big buzz just months ago was Internet blogging. Bloggers are making thousands! True, but nowadays, the multimillionaire blogger is now the exception rather than the rule. Why? The opportunity has been beaten down by ease of entry, causing traffic, competition, and saturation. Saturation causes noise. Noise causes declining sales volumes. Declining sales volumes cause profit erosion. If anyone can start a business in one day or less doing what you do, you probably are violating the Commandment of Entry and tough odds are ahead.

Network marketing, or multi-level marketing (MLM), always fails the Commandment of Entry—unless you own and create the MLM company yourself. If you’re in a room with 2,000 other people who do exactly what you do, you’re fighting stiff odds. Who is the innovator, the leader, and the one standing on a cliff parting the Red Sea? The guy on stage who founded the MLM company is the Fastlaner. And you? Sorry, but you’re just another soldier in his Fastlane army, a cog in his marketing strategy. The MLM founder doesn’t need to climb the pyramid, because *he built the pyramid*! You can be a pyramid builder or a pyramid climber. You can be the sheep or the shepherd.